



Research Article

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Received: 06 October 2025 / Accepted: 12 December 2025 / Published: January 2026

Continuous Education and Lifelong Learning for Enhanced Linguistic Standards in Albanian Public Administration

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DOI: <https://doi.org/10.36941/jesr-2026-0267>

Abstract

The correct use of Standard Albanian in public administration is vital for effective governance, accurate communication, and the maintenance of public trust. This study explores the extent to which standard language is used in Albanian state institutions through questionnaires and interviews with employees of the Ministries of Education, Defense, and Justice. The results indicate that official documents often contain linguistic errors and inconsistencies, reflecting shortcomings in language precision. These issues are largely caused by the absence of standardized document templates, insufficient attention to linguistic norms, and limited opportunities for staff training. Nearly one-third of respondents reported that errors frequently occur in emails and reports addressed to citizens. To address these challenges, the study emphasizes the importance of digital technologies, standardized communication models, and institutional reforms. The use of digital platforms with grammar-checking tools and shared templates can improve consistency and accuracy in official documents. In addition, promoting lifelong learning through continuous professional development and linguistic training can strengthen institutional efficiency, accountability, and public trust in public administration.

Keywords: Lifelong learning, Digital Tools, Training and Professional Development, Linguistic Accuracy, Public Administration, Standard Albanian Language.

1. Introduction

Language, especially the official national language, serves as a symbol of identity, power, and state legitimacy in addition to being a tool for communication. Language is the official means of communicating laws, rules, policies, and services to the public in the field of public administration. Standard Albanian usage in state institutions is therefore a question of both linguistic policy and democratic governance. The clarity, accuracy, and accessibility of administrative language have a direct impact on how citizens view the state: whether they see institutions as professional and transparent or as remote and unapproachable.

Adopting a clear, consistent linguistic standard reduces misinterpretation, prevents ambiguity in legal and administrative texts, and increases public institutions' credibility, as demonstrated by earlier sociolinguistics and public administration research (Crystal, 2010; OECD, 2019). LawBhoomi (n.d.), on the other hand, emphasizes how complicated and inconsistent legal language can alienate citizens, obscure legal obligations, and frustrate citizens trying to navigate bureaucratic systems.

Plain and standardized language has become increasingly important to governments around the world. For instance, the United States' Plain Writing Act (2010) requires all federal agencies to communicate with the public using language that is easy to understand. Similar to this, the Nordic nations and the European Union have implemented rules that make administrative texts easier to understand for a broad audience, irrespective of educational background (Hiidenmaa, 2017). These changes are not merely cosmetic; they have been associated with increased citizen satisfaction with government services, decreased costs in citizen inquiries, and improved efficiency.

In contrast, public administration in Albania continues to face errors and inconsistencies even after the Albanian language was standardized at the 1972 Orthography Congress. The reality on the ground reveals that documents frequently contain stylistic inconsistencies introduced during multiple stages of document approval, dialectal variations that reduce formality, and borrowed foreign terms (e.g., "implementim" instead of the Albanian "zbatim"). According to the study's questionnaire, emails, reports, and citizen correspondence are particularly troublesome because they usually contain a lot of passive constructions, spelling mistakes, and even colloquial language. Administrative texts serve as the legal and communication foundation of governance, so this is no small matter.

The lack of adequate training and resources for staff members is another factor supporting this study. Mistakes, ambiguities, or inconsistent terminology can have real detrimental effects on decision-making processes and the public's perception of institutions. Employees rely on past documents or personal habits in the absence of consistent instruction, which leads to errors being repeated rather than corrected. In addition, although technology could be a useful tool for enhancing language use, its integration into the Albanian government is still minimal. This suggests a lack of appropriate digital tools as well as inadequate institutional support for their use.

The study emphasizes how linguistic errors and inconsistencies cause needless bureaucracy, slow down workflows, and make communication more difficult. By implying a lack of professionalism and consideration, errors in official documents erode public trust in institutions. Ministries can use the study's tangible data—such as percentages, examples, and employee feedback—to help them create focused interventions like training, manuals, and online materials. The study highlights the need for more equitable professional development throughout the administration by exposing the exclusion of contract-based employees from training. This study does more than just describe linguistic issues; it offers evidence-based insights that can be used to improve communication with citizens, strengthen institutional practices, and bring Albanian administration into line with international standards of professionalism and clarity. The findings place Albania in a global context where plain, standardized language is increasingly recognized as a cornerstone of good governance.

2. Literature Review

Both linguistic and governance studies have generally recognized the importance of language in public administration. Academics stress that effective governance, transparency, and citizen engagement all depend on the quality of administrative communication, which is not a trivial issue. Since language serves as a conduit between the general public and governmental institutions, Crystal (2010) asserts that public confidence in institutions is directly correlated with the precision and clarity of official communications.

The significance of standard language in official settings has been the subject of numerous studies. According to Thomai (2014), using non-standard forms in Albanian administrative documents compromises credibility and professionalism. Similarly, Likaj (2018) notes that inconsistent use of the standard language weakens the authority of official documents and causes confusion among employees. These results are consistent with patterns seen in other languages and situations, where deviating from the norm frequently results in misunderstandings and ineffectiveness.

Reforms involving plain language have become popular worldwide as a reaction to the complexity of bureaucracy. While the European Union has released comprehensive guidelines for enhancing clarity in multilingual governance, the United States' Plain Writing Act (2010) mandated that federal agencies create documents that are easily readable by the general public (OECD, 2019). According to Hiidenmaa (2017), plain language programs in Nordic nations, when paired with digital resources and training, resulted in notable gains in institutional effectiveness and citizen satisfaction. These instances show that linguistic reform is both feasible and extremely effective.

There hasn't been much research done on the systematic assessment of administrative language in Albania. The majority of analyses are still theoretical in nature, concentrating on maintaining linguistic purity rather than the real-world difficulties that employees encounter in regular communication. The findings of this study closely match those of Todorova (2016), who focuses on post-socialist administrations in the Balkans and highlights that bureaucratic hierarchies frequently value procedural correctness over linguistic accuracy.

The difficulties in preserving linguistic accuracy in Albanian public administration are fundamentally linked to the nation's intricate history of language standardization. Kryeziu (2018) defines the establishment of Standard Albanian as a politically motivated endeavor that linked language cohesion to the pursuit of national identity. Dulaj (2022) and Shala (2019) note that dialectal variety and inconsistent linguistic conformance persistently influence official communication, resulting in indistinct distinctions between formal and informal speech. This fluidity clarifies several contradictions seen in governmental papers, when deviations from the norm occur not merely due to negligence but as a result of persistent sociolinguistic practices. Kaçi (2016) and Mantho (2009) observe that whereas previous programs effectively standardized grammar and orthography, they seldom engaged with the quotidian linguistic practices within institutions. Veselaj (n.d.) and Muharremi (2025) caution that the absence of continuous oversight and training jeopardizes these linguistic standards, permitting informal registers to infiltrate professional communication. Recent analysis by Xhaferaj (2023) and the OECD/SIGMA (2025) monitoring report indicate that Albania's public administration reforms, especially those associated with European integration, are increasingly acknowledging language quality and digitalization as essential components of institutional modernisation. These findings indicate that enhancing language clarity in public documentation is intrinsically linked to comprehensive structural and cultural reforms within the Albanian state.

The Albanian situation underscores the national aspects of linguistic standardization, while international study contextualizes these issues within global initiatives to professionalize administrative communication. Eckhard (2024a, 2024b) and Gonzalez-Delgado (2024) illustrate

that plain-language policies in European administrations have redefined clarity and accessibility as benchmarks of effective governance. De Swart, den Hengst, and Chen (2025) along with Andersson (2022) demonstrate how digital tools, such as grammar-checking systems, automatic formatting, and common templates, can institutionalize clarity and consistency in governmental papers. Popa (2024) and Szedmák (2025) emphasize that technology is effective only when accompanied with employee flexibility and ongoing digital training. This observation corresponds with the conclusions of Shiri et al. (2023) and Mokhtar (2010), which demonstrate that lifelong learning and self-directed development are essential for maintaining organizational effectiveness. Hamer (2024) and Sung and Choi (2018) substantiate this by illustrating that voluntary engagement in professional training produces more significant and lasting enhancements compared to compulsory instruction. Collectively, these studies suggest that the enhancement of public documentation relies not solely on language policy or technical implementation, but also on fostering a culture of perpetual learning, intrinsic incentive, and institutional accountability. For Albania, this signifies that the standard language should be regarded not alone as a grammatical structure but as a dynamic tool of governance: upheld, enhanced, and utilized through a collective professional ethos.

This review shows that Albania has not yet created comprehensive, evidence-based policies in this area, despite the fact that international literature provides convincing proof of the advantages of linguistic reforms. The current study advances sociolinguistics as a discipline and helps Albanian governance in practice by fusing empirical data with insights from global best practices.

2.1 Goals of the Study

The following goals are pursued by the study:

1. Evaluation of standard language use includes examining institutional communications, official documents, and citizen service delivery.
2. Identifying problems and challenges: Recording the impact of dialects, linguistic borrowings, and training gaps on employees' use of standard Albanian.
3. Assessing employees' knowledge and proficiency in standard Albanian language norms is one way to gauge their awareness and professional readiness.
4. Finding the gaps where interventions like training, new rules, or language resources can improve the standard of language use is known as "areas for improvement."
5. Developing policy recommendations: Outlining specific actions to promote the use of standard Albanian in public administration in order to enhance the caliber and efficacy of institutional communication.

3. Methodology

In order to obtain a thorough grasp of the usage of the standard Albanian language in public administration, the current study used a mixed-methods design, combining quantitative and qualitative techniques. A structured questionnaire that was carefully designed to capture both measurable and descriptive information was the main research instrument. This approach was chosen because, although quantitative data can show the extent and frequency of linguistic issues, qualitative insights help explain the underlying causes and perceptions of employees.

Each section of the questionnaire focused on a different facet of language use in administration:

1. Demographics: gathering data on gender, age, years of work experience, educational attainment, contract type (contractual or civil servant), and institutional role
2. Use of Standard Language: Likert-scale questions measuring how often standard Albanian is used in the workplace by employees.

3. Error Types and Frequency: this section includes questions about the types of documents (emails, reports, memoranda, and citizen correspondence) and the frequency of linguistic errors.
4. Employee perceptions of impact: how much do they think language accuracy influences professionalism, efficiency, and public trust?
5. Training and Resources: both closed-ended and open-ended questions about previous training attendance, manual availability, and perceived areas for improvement.
6. Technology: queries about the function of digital tools (such as grammar and spell checkers) and opinions about their benefits and drawbacks.
7. Participants were given the opportunity to provide specific instances of language issues or their own experiences when drafting official documents in the open-ended section.

3.1 Sampling Strategy

Purposive sampling was the method employed in this study. Participants were drawn from various hierarchical levels (specialists, mid-level managers, and directors) within each ministry to capture differences in language use across professional ranks.

The chosen employees were drawn from three key ministries: the Ministry of Defense, which was chosen due to its intricate documentation processes and heavy reliance on formal communication; the Ministry of Justice, which was chosen due to the high legal and linguistic precision required in legal and judicial documents; and the Ministry of Education, which is included because of its direct communication with schools, teachers, and the public, where clarity is crucial. A more representative picture of the workforce was obtained by including both contract employees and civil servants.

3.2 Data collection

Over the course of four weeks, employees received the questionnaire. Responses were gathered both electronically and in printed form, which was distributed during staff meetings. Participation was entirely voluntary. Higher participation rates and inclusivity for employees in various roles were thus guaranteed. Representatives from each ministry also participated in semi-structured interviews to confirm questionnaire results and gather more detailed information. In addition to personal reflections on institutional culture regarding language use, these interviews offered examples of common errors (like the excessive use of passive voice, superfluous loanwords, and stylistic inconsistencies).

3.3 Data Analysis

Descriptive statistics (percentages, frequencies) were used to analyze quantitative data from closed questions in order to find patterns in attitudes and behaviors. Thematic coding was used to analyze qualitative data from open-ended questions and interviews. For instance, the distribution of responses on error frequency showed that 41% of employees encounter mistakes "sometimes," while 30% encounter them "often." A number of limitations must be noted. The responses were categorized into themes, including "lack of training," "time pressure," "absence of guidelines," and "skepticism about technology." Direct quotes from participants were also included to illustrate findings.

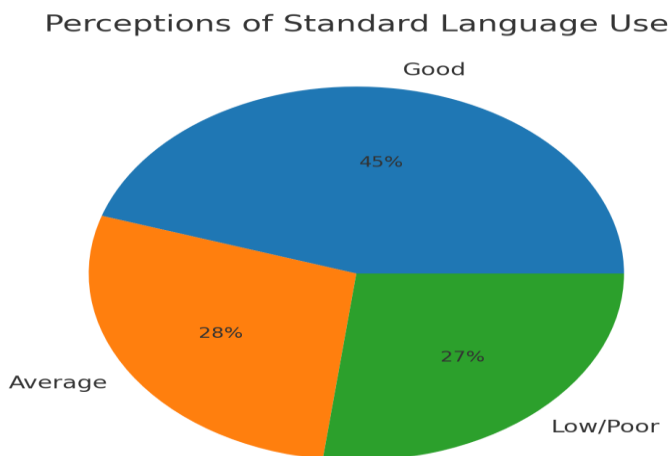
3.4 Limitations

Several limitations must be acknowledged. First, the study only looked at three ministries, which does not include all public institutions (such as municipalities and agencies), even though they are representative of central administration. Second, because self-reported data is used, some responses might represent opinions rather than factual facts. Third, qualitative results should be

considered illustrative rather than exhaustive due to the small number of interviews. Notwithstanding these drawbacks, the study offers one of the most comprehensive overviews of standard Albanian usage in administration to date, complete with statistical support and useful advice.

4. Results

Overall Perceptions of Standard Language Use: According to the questionnaire, staff members in all three ministries acknowledge the value of standard Albanian usage, although there are still issues with its consistent use.



Even among those who rated usage as "good," many acknowledged that documents frequently contain minor errors that are left uncorrected because supervisors prioritize deadlines over perfection. When asked to rate the current level of language correctness in their institutions, 45% evaluated it as "good," 28% as "average," and the remaining respondents as "low" or "poor." One respondent clarified: 'Në fund, nuk ka rëndësi nëse ka një presje më shumë ose një fjalë e huazuar, rëndësi ka që shkresa të dalë në kohë.'¹ This shows a tolerance for minor mistakes that eventually add up to systemic inconsistency. This implies that in reality, supervisors and staff frequently place more importance on content and speed than linguistic accuracy. One respondent from the Ministry of Education, for instance, stated: "Frequency and Types of Errors: While we recognize the importance of adhering to linguistic standards, in practice we often prioritize ensuring that the document is delivered on time rather than that it is written with complete accuracy." Such attitudes highlight a cultural issue: although there is awareness of the importance of correctness, institutional norms allow for compromise.

¹ "In the end, it does not matter if there is an extra comma or a borrowed word; what matters is that the document is issued on time."

4.1 Frequency and Types of Errors:

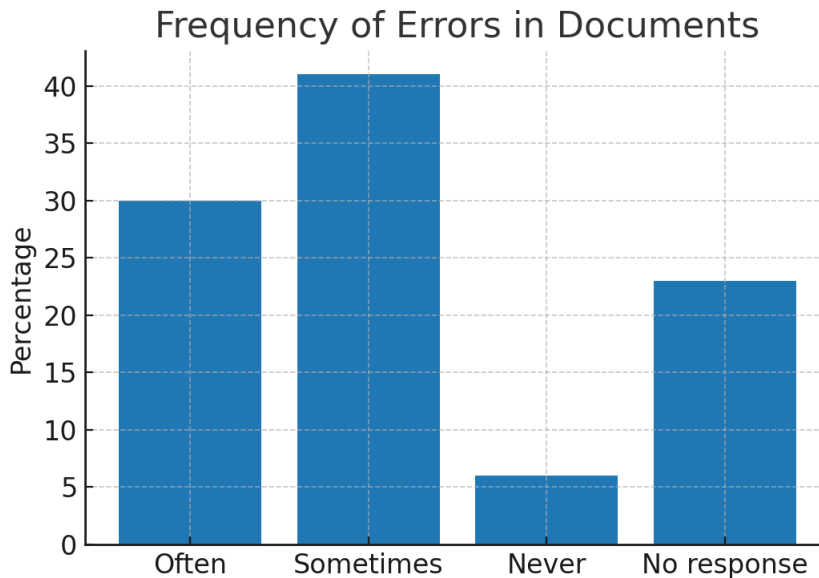


Figure 1. Frequency of Errors in Documents.

When asked how often they encounter linguistic errors in their work, 41% said "sometimes," 30% said "often," and only 6% said "never." This indicates that more than 70% of employees acknowledge that errors are a common occurrence in official documentation. 1) Spelling errors, particularly those involving the letters *ë* and *ç*, were the most frequently found categories of errors. For instance, using "pergjegjesi" rather than "përgjegjësi." 2) Mistakes in punctuation in intricate sentences. 3) Errors in grammar, like subject-verb disagreement. 4) Excessive use of passive constructions results in sentences that lack clarity. 5) English and Italian loanwords, like "implementim" or "targetim. Some employees also noted that informal style slips into formal communication, especially in emails, such as 'Faleminderit shumë për bashkëpunimin e ngrohtë.'² Another example provided was that many official documents used the word "implementim" instead of the native Albanian "zbatim". Another common phrase was "targetimi i grupit" instead of "përcaktimi i grupit". These loanwords create inconsistency and reduce linguistic authenticity.

4.2 Institutional Workflow and Approval Chains

The study found a paradox: despite being intended to guarantee accuracy, the bureaucratic approval process actually makes mistakes possible. A document needs to be signed by seven people in the Ministry of Defense, five in the Ministry of Justice, and four in the Ministry of Education. Nevertheless, errors still exist in the finished product. "The document goes from the department to the chief, then to the director, and each person makes changes according to their own style," explained one expert. Consequently, the approval chain leads to stylistic fragmentation, where each reviewer leaves a "personal trace," rather than standardization, which defeats the very goal of

² Thank you very much for the warm cooperation."

the approval process. The procedure is now bureaucratic and subjective rather than guaranteeing accuracy and consistency.

4.3 Training Opportunities and Resources

One of the clearest findings is the lack of professional training in language use.

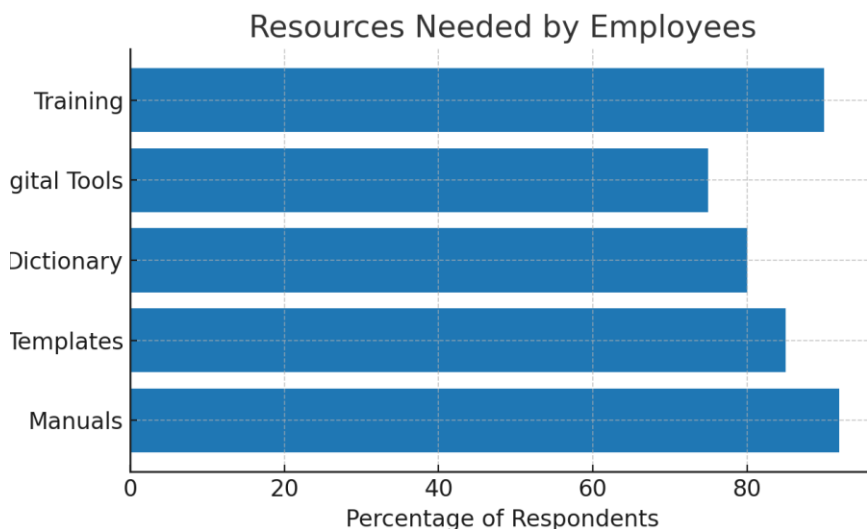


Figure 4. Resources Needed by Employees

Employees themselves are aware of the need for structured support, as evidenced by the horizontal bar chart's overwhelming demand for training, templates, and manuals.

Merely 13% of staff members had participated in administrative training in standard Albanian. Most of them said the sessions were "too short, too theoretical, and without practical examples." In addition, contract employees, who comprise a sizable portion of the workforce, are not given access to training opportunities because the majority of programs are only intended for civil servants. Employees are divided into two groups as a result of this exclusion: those who never receive training and those who do. In the meantime, 92% of participants stated that practical manuals and guidelines are desperately needed. Employees recommended resources such as a quick grammar checklist, a terminology dictionary, and a digital handbook with templates. One respondent summarized the frustration: "Shumë herë nuk dimë si ta shkruajmë saktë. Në vend që të ketë një manual zyrtar, secili kopjon nga letra e mëparshme. Kështu ripërsëriten të njëjtat gabime."³

4.4 Problematic Document Types

According to respondents, there are three document types that are most likely to contain errors: 1) official reports, which use complicated terminology; 2) citizen correspondence, which is drafted hurriedly due to time constraints; and 3) memorandums and emails, which frequently contain

³ English translation: In the absence of an official manual, employees often rely on copying previous letters, which results in the repeated occurrence of the same mistakes."

informal greetings or abbreviations. For example, letters sometimes opened with 'Përshëndetje të nderuar miq' instead of the formal 'I nderuar qytetar'.⁴

4.5 Key Challenges Identified by Employees:

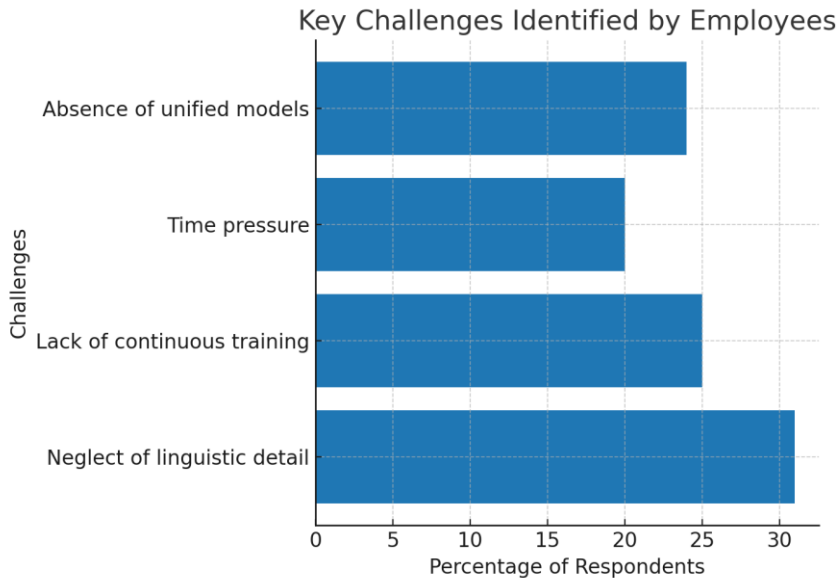


Figure 5 .Resources Needed by Employees.

Employees themselves are aware of the need for structured support, as evidenced by the horizontal bar chart's overwhelming demand for training, templates, and manuals.

Four primary obstacles were confirmed by the survey: 1) Ignorance of linguistic detail—31% of respondents acknowledged that they hardly ever proofread thoroughly. 2) Insufficient ongoing training—25% of respondents highlighted the lack of refresher courses. 3) Time pressure: Employees are frequently compelled to put delivery ahead of accuracy due to deadlines. 4) Lack of unified models—instead of using standardized templates, staff members reuse old documents. A Defense Ministry specialist summed up: 'Kur nuk ke udhëzime të qarta, secili shkruan si di. Kjo është arsyeja pse kemi kaq shumë larmi në shkresa.'⁵

4.7 Technology and Digital Tools

Technology is seen as a potential solution but is not fully trusted. Perceptions of Technology and Digital Tools in Administration

⁴ English translation "Greetings dear friends" formal/administrative: "Dear Citizen" or "Dear Sir/Madam."

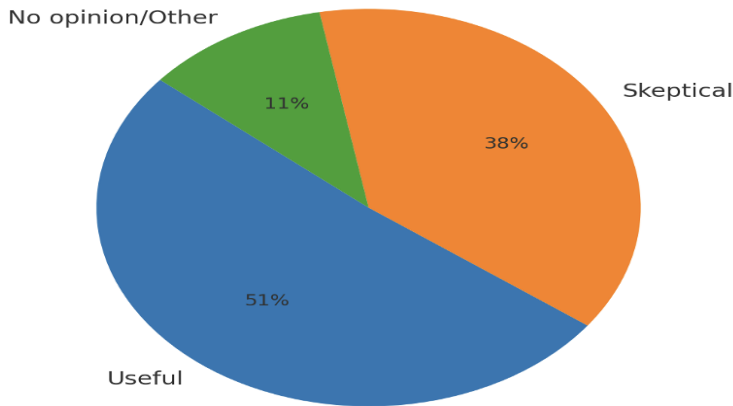


Figure 6. Perceptions of Technology and Digital Tools in Administration.

38% voiced skepticism, pointing to inadequate Albanian adaptation, while 51% claimed grammar checkers helped reduce errors. Certain tools undermined trust by incorrectly flagging words like 'përgjegjës'. As one participant put it: 'Programi shpesh korrigjon gjëra që janë në rregull, kështu që nuk i besojmë më.'⁵ Nevertheless, many concurred that such tools could greatly increase accuracy if they were modified for Albanian and formally promoted.

The study's findings demonstrate the prevalence and systemic nature of linguistic difficulties in Albanian public administration. Employees frequently complained about a variety of issues, from excessive use of loanwords and colloquial language to spelling and punctuation mistakes. Even though the value of linguistic accuracy is widely acknowledged, errors continue to occur because of a lack of structured training, unclear manuals, and a reliance on copying old documents. Instead of increasing accuracy, approval chains add stylistic inconsistency, which makes the process even more difficult. Employees also indicated a high need for useful resources like professional training, standardized templates, and terminology dictionaries. Despite their potential benefits, digital tools are still viewed with skepticism because of their poor Albanian language adaptation. When combined, these results demonstrate the pressing need for systemic change, as employees themselves recognize the scope of the issue and the need for solutions.

5. Discussion

The study's findings point to a complicated yet recurring pattern of difficulties with standard Albanian usage in public administration. Although most staff members understand the value of linguistic accuracy, systemic obstacles such as insufficient resources, bureaucratic processes, and a lack of training make it difficult for them to consistently apply the standard. These results not only support previous findings regarding linguistic deficiencies in Albanian institutions (Thomai, 2014; Likaj, 2018), but they also offer fresh empirical information regarding the scope, frequency, and character of the issues.

⁵ English translation "The program often corrects elements that are already correct, which is why we no longer trust it."

5.1 Awareness vs. Practice

5.1.1 The discrepancy between awareness and practice is among the most notable findings.

The vast majority of employees (87%) concur that linguistic accuracy directly raises the caliber of work and strengthens the institution's reputation. The fact that 41% of respondents say they make mistakes "sometimes" and 30% say they do so "often" indicates that awareness alone is not enough to translate linguistic ideals into everyday practice; structural reforms and resource provision are needed. This is consistent with findings from international research on plain language reforms, which found that in order to achieve long-lasting improvements, institutions needed to undergo cultural change (OECD, 2019).

5.1.2 Bureaucratic Workflows and the Illusion of Control

The study also emphasizes how ineffectual approval chains are. Having four to seven signatures on a document does not ensure that it is accurate. Instead, there is often inconsistency because each reviewer tends to leave their own stylistic marks. This illustrates a systemic problem: bureaucracy devoid of explicit language standards causes division rather than advancement. Similar issues have been noted in other post-socialist administrations where quality and efficiency are subordinated to hierarchical control (Todorova, 2016). According to this finding, Albania should focus its institutional efforts on creating and implementing standardized templates and manuals rather than reiterating approvals.

5.1.3 Training Gaps and Resource Deficits

One of the most important problems is the absence of opportunities for professional development. It is concerning that contract-based employees, who make up a significant portion of the workforce, are completely excluded from training programs, resulting in a two-tier system of linguistic competence. Only 13% of employees had received training in language use, and even these sessions were deemed "too short and too theoretical." Employees themselves acknowledge the need for practical support, as evidenced by the nearly unanimous (92%) call for manuals and guidelines. This finding is consistent with global experiences where improving administrative language required accessible manuals and continual professional development (Hiidenmaa, 2017).

5.1.4 The Role of Technology

Potential vs. Distrust: This study shows that technology has two sides. On the one hand, according to 51% of respondents, spell-checkers and other similar tools help cut down on errors. However, 38% of respondents voiced skepticism, pointing to inaccurate error flags (such as marking "përgjegjësi" as incorrect) and inadequate language adaptation in Albanian. This conflict emphasizes how urgently Albanian-specific digital tools are needed. Such instruments could significantly raise the caliber of language if they were created and supported institutionally. According to the Nordic countries' experience, incorporating grammar checkers and plain language platforms into all official writing systems greatly decreased error rates (Hiidenmaa, 2017).

5.1.5 Problematic Genres of Writing

The most problematic document types were found to be emails, reports, and citizen correspondence. Each reflects a distinct challenge: emails frequently combine personal and professional registers, undermining formality; citizen correspondence is susceptible to hurried

writing and inappropriate tone; and reports suffer from technical jargon and inconsistent terminology.

5.1.6 Broader Implications for Governance

The linguistic weaknesses found here are not just technical errors; they have wider implications for governance. These findings emphasize that different genres require different strategies, such as technical glossaries for reports, style guides for correspondence, and digital etiquette training for emails. Inadequately written documents, especially those pertaining to justice, increase the risk of legal ambiguity, slow down administrative procedures, and erode public trust. Therefore, increasing the use of standard Albanian in administration is directly related to increasing effectiveness, openness, and democratic legitimacy.

5.1.7 Alignment with International Best Practices

The difficulties encountered in Albania are similar to those faced by other nations that implemented language reforms. Improving administrative language is both possible and effective, as shown by the Nordic Council's plain language initiatives, the EU's language simplification guidelines, and the United States' Plain Writing Act (2010). Therefore, reforms can be guided by lessons learned from other contexts, and Albania's situation is not unique. To address these issues, a comprehensive strategy combining digital innovation, professional development, cultural change, and standardized resources is needed.

5.1.8 Continuous Education and Lifelong Learning for Enhanced Linguistic Standards

Effective governance, accurate communication, and public trust rely on the appropriate use of the standard Albanian language in public administration. This study examines the extent of its utilization in Albanian state institutions through questionnaires and interviews with personnel from the Ministry of Education, Ministry of Defense, and Ministry of Justice. Data indicates that government documents often exhibit errors and inconsistencies, reflecting a medium to poor degree of linguistic precision. The absence of standardized templates, neglect of linguistic nuances, and the staff's restricted training chances are among the principal concerns identified. Nearly one-third of respondents admitted that errors are often included in emails and reports dispatched to citizens. The study advocates for the implementation of digital technologies, standardized models, and institutional reforms to enhance language efficiency and correctness.

The incorporation of technology in public administration is essential for enhancing linguistic standards and institutional efficacy. Digital platforms featuring grammar-checking capabilities, automated formatting, and centralized repositories can significantly minimize errors and discrepancies in official documents. The methodical application of common templates among ministries guarantees consistency and precision in communication. Besides improving productivity, these electronic solutions promote openness and accountability by enabling the traceability and accessibility of administrative documents.

The encouragement of continuing education through the concept of lifelong learning is equally essential. Consistent professional development, including workshops, specialized linguistic training, or digital literacy courses, provides government workers with the skills necessary to adjust to changing communication standards. Lifelong learning as an institutional philosophy transitions the emphasis from sporadic training programs to continuous capacity development throughout an employee's career. Embedding a culture of continuous development in public administration enhances individual performance and strengthens collective accountability, ultimately bolstering governance, institutional reliability, and public trust.

6. Recommendations

The results of this study demonstrate that linguistic deficiencies in Albanian public administration are systemic problems that impact effectiveness, professionalism, and public trust rather than being isolated occurrences. A thorough and multi-layered approach incorporating resource development, professional training, structural reforms, and cultural change is needed to address these issues. The suggestions that follow are intended to offer workable, fact-based fixes that specifically address the issues mentioned in the Results section. In addition to fixing mistakes, they are meant to create a long-term, sustainable framework for raising the standard of administrative communication and bringing Albania into line with global best practices in language policy and governance.

6.1 *Develop a Standardized Manual of Administrative Language*

The lack of a single authoritative source for official writing is one of the most obvious needs identified by the study. Employees currently rely on copying older documents or using their own discretion, which leads to a patchwork of styles and frequent mistakes. For all administrative correspondence, including official letters, reports, and memoranda, a standardized handbook would offer consistent guidelines, models, and examples. This would lessen reliance on supervisors' subjective corrections and personal preferences, which were found to be significant sources of inconsistency in the results. A well-written handbook would also be used as a training tool, guaranteeing that both novice and seasoned staff members could match their writing to the requirements of the organization. Examples from other countries attest to its efficacy: the U.S. Measurable gains in efficiency and clarity have resulted from the Federal Plain Language Guidelines and the EU's administrative communication handbooks. In order to guarantee that the standard language is both formally correct and understandable by its citizens, Albania could modify.

6.2. *Create Ready-to-Use Templates*

Memorandums, reports, and citizen correspondence are the most prone to errors, according to the study. The use of digital templates that are pre-formatted, pre-structured, and pre-toned is one remedy. Standard subject headings, formal greetings and closings, and appropriate paragraph and signature formatting are a few examples of these templates. Employees would then only have to add the relevant content, significantly lowering the possibility of improper tone or grammatical errors. Additionally, templates would guarantee uniformity amongst institutions, ensuring that a letter from the Ministry of Justice would sound and look the same as one from the Ministry of Education. This goes beyond aesthetics; it tackles professionalism and public trust head-on. Standardized templates have increased public satisfaction with government communication and expedited administrative procedures in nations like Sweden and Canada

6.3. *Compile a Terminology Dictionary*

The use of needless foreign borrowings, such as "implementim" rather than "zbatim," was one of the most recurring issues found in the data. Standardized Albanian equivalents for technical and foreign terms would be provided by a national terminology dictionary for administrative language. A resource like this would stop various ministries from using disparate terminology to refer to the same idea, which currently leads to misunderstandings and inconsistencies. For instance, official discourse may become fragmented if one ministry uses the English-based "targetim," while another uses the "synim." In addition to strengthening the Albanian language's authenticity and reducing

reliance on foreign linguistic models, a centralized dictionary would standardize terminology. Such an endeavor is possible even in complex contexts, as evidenced by the EU's success in preserving uniformity across its 24 official languages through centralized terminology databases. Such a dictionary, which would guarantee accuracy and usability, could be created in Albania in cooperation with linguists, academic institutions, and government agencies. Training Programs That Are Both Required and Inclusive.

6. 4. Mandatory and Inclusive Training Programs

Reforms are desperately needed in the crucial area of training. Only 13% of employees had ever participated in language use training, according to the study, and these sessions were deemed overly theoretical. Even worse, contract employees, who comprise a significant portion of the workforce, are completely disqualified from training. This establishes a two-tiered system in which some employees are given professional development opportunities while others are left to fend for themselves. All employees, regardless of contract type, must be required to participate in training programs in order to address this. Additionally, they ought to be practical and hands-on, with exercises modeled after actual documents created by ministries. Employees could, for example, practice editing and revising reports or memoranda that have flaws, learning by fixing real mistakes. Training ought to be an ongoing process with refresher courses held every 12 to 18 months rather than a one-time occurrence. Albania would be more in line with the practices of nations like Finland and Denmark, where public employees receive regular training in communication standards as part of their professional development, if training were made mandatory.

6.5. Establish Continuous Professional Development Platforms

In addition to face-to-face training, ministries should invest in online platforms for continuous professional development. Interactive grammar and style modules, video lessons, tests, and downloadable materials like glossaries and mini-guides are a few examples of these platforms. Employees could create a sense of community and shared responsibility for language use by posting questions in a discussion forum and receiving knowledgeable responses. Employees in remote locations or smaller towns who might not have easy access to in-person training would find such platforms especially helpful. Institutions would guarantee that linguistic competency is available to everyone, everywhere, and at all times by making resources available online. This strategy is in line with global trends in digital learning, where e-learning platforms are now commonplace resources for career advancement. Such a platform would lessen Albania's reliance on infrequent training sessions by fostering a culture of lifelong learning.

6.6. Integrate and Promote Technological Tools

The study showed that while some employees see the value of grammar and spell-check tools, many remain skeptical due to poor adaptation to Albanian. This emphasizes the necessity of locally relevant digital resources that are especially designed for the Albanian language. Ministries should integrate these tools directly into their document management systems so that every official text is automatically checked for spelling, grammar, and style before being approved. Training sessions should also demonstrate how to use these tools effectively, addressing the current mistrust among employees. By doing so, institutions could prevent recurring mistakes such as omitted diacritics (ë, ç) and inconsistent verb usage. In Nordic countries, similar tools are mandatory in official writing, and their widespread use has significantly reduced error rates. For Albania, investing in

technology would not only reduce mistakes but also increase efficiency, as employees would spend less time proofreading manually

6.7. Monitor and Evaluate Progress

To ensure that reforms are effective, they must be accompanied by systematic monitoring and evaluation. Ministries should regularly measure the frequency and type of errors in official documents and compare them before and after interventions such as training or manual distribution. Annual surveys could also collect employee feedback on the usefulness of manuals, templates, and digital tools. Evaluation reports should be made public to ensure transparency and accountability. Without such mechanisms, even well-designed reforms risk being forgotten or ignored over time. Monitoring would provide the data necessary to adjust strategies and ensure that reforms remain relevant and effective. Countries like the UK and the Netherlands have successfully used monitoring systems to evaluate the impact of plain language reforms, and Albania could adopt similar models.

6.8. Promote a Culture of Linguistic Care

Employees must see linguistic accuracy not as a minor detail but as an essential part of professionalism and respect for citizens. To encourage this, institutions could recognize and reward employees who consistently produce error-free documents, perhaps through symbolic awards or acknowledgment in staff evaluations. Supervisors could incorporate linguistic accuracy into performance reviews, signaling that it is a valued skill. Awareness campaigns within institutions could emphasize that correct language use builds public trust and strengthens democratic legitimacy. The study revealed that many employees ignore details due to time pressure; cultural change would encourage them to prioritize accuracy as much as efficiency. In this way, linguistic care would become a shared responsibility across all levels of administration, not just a task for editors or reviewers.

7. Conclusion

The results of this study demonstrate that standard Albanian usage in public administration is still irregular, prone to mistakes, and not adequately backed by institutional frameworks. Although employees are generally aware of the significance of linguistic accuracy, systemic barriers—such as convoluted approval processes that cannot ensure correctness, a lack of standardized resources, a lack of exclusive training opportunities, and a lack of technology utilization—shape administrative practice in reality. These challenges have a direct impact on public trust and the state's perceived professionalism, as well as the internal effectiveness of institutions and the public perception of government.

The evidence indicates that official reports, citizen correspondence, and internal memorandums—documents essential to governance and citizen engagement—are the most likely to contain errors. Employees acknowledge that they frequently duplicate older documents, which leads to errors being repeated. The issue is made worse by time constraints and a lack of training. The enduring use of informal expressions, stylistic inconsistencies, and foreign loanwords emphasizes the necessity of comprehensive reforms as opposed to patchwork fixes.

The study also shows that there are workable and practical solutions. Employees themselves are aware of the issue and want assistance, as evidenced by the overwhelmingly high demand (92%) for manuals, guidelines, and templates. Likewise, the polarized view of technology, with 51% appreciating it and 38% disbelieving it, implies that digital tools may have a transformative potential with the right training and adaptation. These results are consistent with global

experiences where training initiatives, digital tools, and plain language policies have effectively increased governance's accessibility, effectiveness, and clarity.

From a wider angle, this study emphasizes that language in administration is a democratic necessity rather than just a technical problem. Citizens are guaranteed to comprehend their rights, responsibilities, and the services provided by the government when communication is accurate, clear, and easily accessible. On the other hand, badly written documents run the risk of being misunderstood, delayed, and distrusted. Therefore, enhancing the use of standard Albanian is a step toward transparency, institutional credibility, and good governance.

In the future, Albania can invest in training programs, standardized manuals, readily usable templates, and locally relevant digital tools to bring itself into line with global best practices. To make sure that linguistic care becomes a part of the institution's identity rather than an afterthought, these reforms should be combined with monitoring systems and cultural change initiatives. The sociolinguistic dynamics of administrative language, the function of digital tools in linguistic standardization, and the long-term consequences of plain language policies in transitional democracies are all topics that this study lays the groundwork for future research on. In conclusion, it is not only vital but also urgent to implement explicit policies, materials, and cultural initiatives to enhance the use of standard Albanian in public administration. It will improve public confidence, increase administrative effectiveness, and bring Albania closer to global norms for professionalism and clarity. It is an investment in the legitimacy, credibility, and democratic efficacy of state institutions rather than just a question of linguistic accuracy.

Acknowledgment

This study was conducted within the framework of the project "Improving Public, Central, and Local Administration's Human Resource Quality in the Preparation and Design of Official Documentation", supported by the Agency for Quality Assurance in Higher Education (AKKSHI). The research was funded under the "Call for Project Proposals within the Framework of the National Scientific Research Programs for the Year 2024 (PKKSH and PTI)". This funding initiative aims to encourage rigorous research projects that enhance institutional capacity, promote professional development, and contribute to evidence-based improvements in public administration in Albania.

The authors are deeply grateful to AKKSHI for their financial and institutional support, which made it possible to undertake a comprehensive investigation of linguistic practices in Albanian state institutions. The project specifically examined the use of the standard Albanian language in official documentation across the Ministry of Education, Ministry of Defense, and Ministry of Justice, highlighting areas where errors, inconsistencies, and insufficient training affect administrative communication.

We would also like to sincerely thank all personnel and respondents from the ministries who generously shared their time, expertise, and experiences. Their participation was invaluable for identifying practical challenges, such as the lack of standardized templates, limited training opportunities, and recurring errors in official correspondence. Their insights directly informed the study's recommendations for technological integration, standardized models, and continuous professional development initiatives.

Finally, the authors extend appreciation to all colleagues, advisors, and collaborators who provided guidance, feedback, and encouragement throughout the research process. Their contributions were crucial in ensuring the quality, rigor, and relevance of this study, which ultimately aims to strengthen governance, institutional reliability, and public trust in Albanian public administration.

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